

∩ C13 · CLOSENESS

The Listening Experiment

The Science and Experience of Closeness

The Listening Experiment

Uninterrupted speech, then the meaning returned, then a minute to correct it. You swap with equal time.

1. Name a finishable topic, and say if it is good news. The listener may decline what they cannot hold. The second turn is equal.
2. Six uninterrupted minutes. You need not fill them. No advice, no matching story, and no question during the turn.
3. About two minutes: I heard, for the content, and it sounded like you felt, for the feeling. On grief, worry, or anger, no silver lining.
4. One correction minute. The listener may ask what they missed, and does not argue. Swap. The second speaker still has six minutes.

Talk about the process if you want. Advice waits for a separate yes.

A reflection is not agreement, and it is not therapy. If the story is harm, leave the exercise. Being heard is not immunity.

A pause for a break is allowed. Declining the topic, or stopping, completes the session.